VOLUME 9 — MODEL PAPER 4 (Difficulty: Difficult) · 2026-STYLE ALL-SUBJECTIVE FORMAT

NID DAT (B.Des) Prelims: Practice Model Paper 4
*This paper mirrors the **reported structure of the actual DAT 2026 Prelims (Dec 2025)**: no objective section; 6 long questions with sub-parts (13 tasks here) in 3 hours. That structure is [REPORTED] from candidate memory and is not officially confirmed. This practice paper was written for this package; it is not an official NID paper.*

INSTRUCTIONS

1. Time: **3 hours (180 min)**. Total: **100 marks**. Attempt **all** questions.
2. Use one A4 sheet (or answer-booklet page) per question. Pencil, colour pencils, pastels and pens are allowed.
3. Read every question fully before starting. Note the counts, viewpoints and users.
4. Suggested timing (≈ 1.65 min per mark, plus a 10-minute buffer):

Q	Marks	Time
Q1	18	30 min
Q2	18	30 min
Q3	14	23 min
Q4	16	26 min
Q5	18	30 min
Q6	16	26 min
Reading + buffer	—	15 min

QUESTIONS

Q1. Observation, Perspective & Critique (18 marks)
(a) Draw the inside of a **crowded city bus on a rainy morning**, as seen from the **conductor's seat near the rear door**. Show at least **10 passengers** (12 marks).
(b) In your drawing, mark and number **three design problems** you can see (3 marks).
(c) In **two lines each**, suggest a fix for any **two** of them (3 marks).

Q2. Sequential Storytelling (18 marks)
In **five frames**, show what happens when a **street vendor's cart breaks a wheel in the middle of a busy road**: how people around respond, and how the situation is resolved. The **last frame** must show a **design improvement** that would prevent or reduce the problem in future.

Q3. Empathy Kit (14 marks)
(a) Draw, as a neat **flat-lay (knolled) arrangement**, everything a **visually impaired Class 9 student** needs for a school day. Label each item (8 marks).
(b) Choose **one** item and redesign it to work better for this student. Show the redesign with labels (6 marks).

Q4. Food, Culture & Writing (16 marks)
(a) Illustrate a **regional festival dish being prepared** (for example: modak, pitha, puran poli, sarson ka saag, appam). Show the dish, the cooking vessel, the key ingredients and the hands of the person cooking (10 marks).
(b) In about **150 words**, describe this dish to someone who has never seen or tasted it (6 marks).

Q5. Visual Communication System (18 marks)
Your town is introducing a **ban on single-use plastic bags at its weekly market (haat)**.
(a) Design **four signboards** for the market that work as a consistent system (8 marks).
(b) Design a **poster** announcing the ban (6 marks).
(c) Design a graphic for a **reusable cloth bag** that the municipality will distribute (4 marks).

Q6. Imagination (16 marks)
(a) **Object completion.** You are given this starting shape: *a circle with a short vertical line rising from its top*. Complete it into **three different objects**, one per box (6 marks).
(b) **"What if the footpaths of your city could change shape depending on who walks on them?"** Draw one scene that shows this idea working for at least **three different users** (10 marks).

ANSWER KEY (Compact: what must appear for full credit)

Q	Must-have elements
1(a)	Rear-door eye level; 1-point perspective down the aisle; 10+ passengers (standing, holding grab handles, seated); umbrellas dripping, wet floor, fogged windows, raincoats; the conductor's ticket machine
1(b)	Three numbered problems visible in the drawing (e.g. wet slippery floor, grab handles out of reach of short passengers, no umbrella storage, a high entry step)
1(c)	Two specific, feasible fixes (drainage-grooved anti-slip floor; hanging straps at two heights; umbrella sleeves or holders)
2	5 frames with continuity; escalating then resolving traffic; cooperation shown; frame 5 = design improvement (spare-wheel clamp, a stronger axle, a quick-jack kit, a wheel guard)
3(a)	10–14 labelled items (white cane, Braille slate and stylus, Braille books, audio player / screen-reader phone, tactile ruler, talking calculator, tiffin with tactile markers, water bottle with a textured grip, ID card with Braille, wide-ruled notebook for low vision, magnifier if low-vision) in a neat grid
3(b)	One redesigned item with labels: a clear user benefit, tactile or audio features
4(a)	The dish shown being prepared (e.g. modak being pleated), a vessel (steamer / ukadiche patra), ingredients labelled (rice flour, jaggery, coconut, cardamom), hands in action, colour, appetite appeal
4(b)	~150 words covering appearance, texture, taste, aroma, the festival context and how it is eaten; vivid sensory language
5(a)	4 consistent signs (shape, colour code, icon style); bilingual; e.g. "No plastic bags", "Cloth bag counter →", "Return & reuse point", "Fine ₹___ for plastic"; placement shown
5(b)	Strong headline + one big visual idea + date/venue + call to action
5(c)	A bag graphic that people want to reuse: local identity, a durable 1–2 colour print, a message
6(a)	Three distinct, recognisable objects from different categories (e.g. an apple with a stem, a wall clock on its hook, a cartoon bomb with a fuse, a magnifying glass, a lollipop)
6(b)	A coherent speculative scene; 3+ users with different needs (wheelchair user → ramp forms; child → playful bumps or guidance; elderly → handrails rise; blind → tactile strips); mechanism hinted; perspective

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DETAILED SOLUTIONS & MODEL APPROACHES

Q1 (18 marks)

(a) Drawing approach (12 marks)

- **Viewpoint:** the conductor sits near the rear door, at seated eye level (about 1.1 m), looking forward up the aisle. Use one-point perspective with the VP near the front windscreen. The ceiling and its grab rails converge toward the VP, and so do the floor lines and seat rows.
- **Passengers (10+):**
  - a standing office-goer holding a strap with a dripping umbrella
  - a schoolgirl with a wet raincoat
  - an elderly man seated in the reserved seat
  - a mother holding a toddler
  - a man with a vegetable sack
  - two college students sharing earphones
  - a woman wringing her dupatta
  - a man reading a phone
  - a passenger on the footboard
  - the driver's back in the distance
- **Rain details:**
  - fogged windows with trickles
  - a puddle on the floor
  - folded umbrellas dripping
  - wet footprints
  - plastic covers over bags
  - the grey light outside
- **Composition:** strong converging lines lead to the windscreen; foreground figures overlap the frame edges, which creates a sense of crowding.

(b) Three problems (3 marks). Example set:

1. Wet, slippery floor near the door, a fall risk.
2. Overhead grab rails too high for short passengers and children.
3. No place for wet umbrellas, so passengers drip onto others.
   Others that count: a high first step; ticket counting in a crush; no priority-seat signage visible.

(c) Two fixes (3 marks):

- "Fit a grooved, anti-slip rubber floor near the doors that drains water into side channels."
- "Add hanging straps at two heights (1.6 m and 1.8 m) so children and shorter adults can hold on."
- *Alternatives:* umbrella sleeves (a dispenser of recyclable sleeves at the door) or a vertical umbrella rack; a kneeling or low-floor bus.

Rubric: (a) perspective 4 + crowd/proportion 4 + rain observation 2 + composition 2; (b) 1 per valid, visible problem; (c) 1.5 per specific, feasible fix.

Common mistakes: drawing from the front; fewer than 10 people; problems that are not visible in the drawing; vague fixes ("make it better").

Q2 (18 marks)

Model 5-frame plan

Frame	Shot	Content
1	Wide	A vendor pushes a fruit cart across a busy junction; vehicles all around
2	Medium	Crack! A wheel snaps; bananas roll onto the road; the cart tilts; horns blare
3	Wide	Traffic jams; an auto driver gets out to help; a student picks up the fruit; a traffic policeman signals the vehicles
4	Medium	Three people lift the cart to the footpath; a mechanic from a nearby cycle shop brings a spare wheel; the vendor's relieved face
5	Close-up + inset	**Design improvement:** the redesigned cart has a **built-in fold-down kick-stand jack** and a **spare-wheel clip** under the base, plus **thicker solid-rubber wheels on a steel-hub axle**. A label reads: "Jack + spare: 2 min fix, no road block."

Rubric (18): narrative logic 4; continuity (same vendor, cart and location) 3; shot variety and composition 3; emotion and community response 3; design improvement quality 4; finish 1.
Mistakes: a final frame without a design idea; inconsistent characters; overcrowded, unreadable frames.

Q3 (14 marks)

(a) Knolling layout (8 marks). Arrange the items on a clean grid, all aligned at 90°, with labels below:

1. White cane (foldable)
2. Braille slate and stylus
3. Braille textbooks
4. Smartphone with screen reader + earphones
5. Tactile geometry kit (raised-line ruler, protractor)
6. Talking calculator
7. Tiffin with tactile-dot lids (to identify the compartments)
8. Water bottle with a textured grip band
9. Braille ID card on a lanyard
10. Bag with distinct textured pockets
11. Abacus (Cranmer type)
12. Bold-line notebook + magnifier (if low vision)

Rubric: item relevance 4, layout neatness 2, labels 2.

(b) Redesign (6 marks), model: "Feel-Find School Bag"

- Each pocket has a different texture patch: ridges = books, dots = tiffin, smooth = electronics.
- A **sound tag** on the zipper pull helps locate the bag; a magnetic flap replaces fiddly zips on the front pocket.
- Reflective strips for low-vision students and for safety.

Rubric: user insight 2, feature clarity 2, drawing and labels 2.

Mistakes: treating every visually impaired student as totally blind (low vision exists, so the magnifier and bold lines count); a cluttered layout.

Q4 (16 marks)

(a) Illustration (10 marks), example: ukadiche modak for Ganesh Chaturthi

- **Scene:** a close-up of a kitchen counter. One pair of hands pleats a modak around the filling, while finished modaks sit in a steel steamer plate lined with banana leaf.

- **Labelled ingredients in small bowls:** rice-flour dough, grated coconut + jaggery filling, cardamom, ghee. The steamer (ukadiche patra) gives off steam.
- **Composition:** the hands and modak at a thirds point, with the ingredients arranged in an arc around them.
- **Colour:** warm creams, golden jaggery and banana-leaf green.

Rubric: accuracy of the dish and process 3; hands in action 2; ingredients labelled 2; composition 2; appetite appeal and colour 1.

(b) Model ~150-word description:

> Ukadiche modak is a small steamed dumpling made for Ganesh Chaturthi in Maharashtra. It looks like a white garlic bulb or a closed lotus bud, with about eleven neat pleats meeting at a pointed tip. The outer shell is made from rice flour cooked into a soft dough, so it is thin, smooth and slightly sticky. Inside is a warm, golden filling of freshly grated coconut cooked with jaggery and a pinch of cardamom, which smells sweet and earthy. When you bite into it, the soft shell gives way to a juicy, gently crunchy centre. Families serve it hot, with a spoon of ghee poured into the opened top. Making modaks is a family ritual: grandmothers teach children to pleat them, because a perfect modak is a sign of patience and care. It is believed to be Lord Ganesha's favourite sweet.

(About 150 words.)

Rubric: sensory detail 2, clarity for a newcomer 2, cultural context 1, word limit 1.

Q5 (18 marks)

(a) Signage system (8 marks)

- **System rules:** 60 × 40 cm boards on bamboo poles (local and cheap); a green border = positive action, a red circle-slash = prohibition; a uniform icon style (thick line); bilingual (local language + English).
- **Four signs:**
    1. "No plastic bags": a bag with a red slash.
    2. "Cloth bag counter →": a cloth-bag icon with an arrow.
    3. "Bring your bag. Save ₹5": a bag + coin icon.
    4. "Plastic return point": a bin with returning arrows (for collecting old bags).
- **Placement sketch:** at the haat entrance and at the decision points between stall rows.

(b) Poster (6 marks), concept: a vegetable seller's basket shaped like the Earth, with produce on top and a cloth bag strap as the handle. Headline: "**Haat goes plastic-free from 1 January.**" Sub-line: "Carry a cloth bag. Every bag counts." A municipality logo and a QR code for details. Colours: green, earth brown, white.

(c) Cloth bag graphic (4 marks): a one-colour screen-print of a stylised market scene (stall umbrellas and baskets) in a block-print style inspired by local textiles, with the tagline "Mera Thaila, Meri Shaan" (My bag, my pride). It is durable, appealing, and has a local identity people are proud to carry.

Rubric: (a) consistency 3 + clarity 3 + placement 2; (b) concept 3 + hierarchy 2 + details 1; (c) appeal 2 + reusability logic 2.

Q6 (16 marks)

(a) Object completion (6 marks). Three objects from different categories score better than three similar ones. Examples:

1. **Apple** (a circle with a stem and a leaf added)
2. **Wall clock** (the line becomes the hanging hook; numbers and hands inside)
3. **Cartoon bomb with a lit fuse**
   Also acceptable: a balloon (with the line as the string, flipped), a magnifying glass (with the line as the handle), a lollipop, an onion, a planet with an antenna (a satellite), a cherry, a musical note, a sitar gourd.

Rubric: 2 per object = recognisability 1 + originality or category spread 1.

(b) Speculative footpath scene (10 marks)

- **Concept:** smart modular pavement tiles that sense the user (via a footstep pattern, a cane tap or a wheel load) and reshape.
- **Users and responses:**
  - **wheelchair user:** the kerb tiles slide down into a ramp; rough tiles flatten
  - **visually impaired person:** raised tactile guidance lines appear and lead to the crossing
  - **elderly woman:** a handrail rises from the edge; a bench folds out at intervals
  - **child:** a playful hopscotch pattern lights up, but only in the safe zone
- **Drawing:** a street in 2-point perspective; callouts with arrows explain each transformation; a small inset shows the tile mechanism (pistons or modules).

Rubric: idea coherence 3, users' needs addressed 3, perspective and scene quality 2, explanation and callouts 2.

Mistakes: an imaginative scene that doesn't show a single user benefit; vague magic without even a hinted mechanism.

SCORING INTERPRETATION — MODEL PAPER 4

Practice benchmarks only, not NID cutoffs.

Score	Band	Note
72–100	**Excellent**	You can handle the 2026-style format
58–71	**Strong**	Polish time management
45–57	**Good**	Work on finishing all 13 tasks
30–44	**Needs improvement**	Speed drills: 12-minute sketches
< 30	**Major improvement required**	Revisit Vol 3 fundamentals

Key metric for this format: *completion rate*. Track how many of the 13 tasks you fully completed. The target is 13/13 with at least 70% polish each.

NEXT VOLUME: Volume 10 — Model Paper 5 (Full Mock Simulation) (`10-VOL10-MODEL-PAPER-5-FULL-MOCK.md`)